

Slithering snakes

Snakes can survive anywhere, from cold climates to the hot deserts and rainforests of the world – you can even find them underwater.

Getting around

Snakes have no arms and no legs. Instead they have a bendy body that wriggles. Some slither in a straight line, others like this viper wiggle in an “s” shape.



A snake's forked tongue flicks in the air to smell food or alert it to enemies.

Red-tailed racer

Snakes have no eyelids, so they cannot blink.

Types of snake

Snakes can be divided into four different groups, or families.



Typical snakes: this family is the biggest of the four.



Vipers: they have venomous fangs and live in the hot places.



Constrictors: kill their prey by squeezing them to death.



Cobras and kraits: they are some of the most deadly creatures alive.

Snake senses

Snakes can't see or hear very well, but they can smell much better than you or me. They use their forked tongues to smell and taste the air around them.

Turn and learn

Snake defence:
pp. 92-93
Snake-like eel:
p. 149

